

a Champions League spot, took a step in the right direction and in style after thrashing lowly Valladolid 7-1 as the misfortunes of the Ronaldo Nazario-owned team continued.

After gameweek 25, Barcelona leads the standings with 54 points. Real Madrid, also on 54 points, stays second due to its inferior head-to-head record. Atletico has a point less than its city rival and is third in the table, while Athletic is fourth with 48 points.

Bundesliga

Xabi Alonso and his boys might not have been able to emulate the invincible form from last season but they have continued to set records.

With Bayer Leverkusen's 2-0 win over relegation-threatened Holstein Kiel, Alonso extended his unbeaten run in away games to 28 in the Bundesliga (W20 D8) — a record.

Meanwhile, midfielder Florian Wirtz reached double figures in assists in consecutive seasons of the league — only Salah has managed to do so in each of the last two seasons in Europe's big five leagues.

Leverkusen had six draws in its last season, which it won. With 11 games left to play, it has already drawn eight games,

leaving it second in the standings below Bayern Munich, which is looking to win its first league title under manager Vincent Kompany.

Kompany's side had missed out on automatic qualification in the Champions League after finishing 12th in the standings. But the Bavarians have picked up tempo since, qualifying for the round of 16 with a playoff win against Celtic.

In the league, they continued to march forward with a 4-0 victory over 2022 Europa League champion Eintracht Frankfurt, extending its lead to eight points.

Serie A

Lautaro Martinez made history with Inter Milan as the Nerazzurri returned to winning ways against Genoa, after suffering a narrow defeat to

Consistent: Lautaro Martinez became the first overseas player at Inter Milan to reach double figures in goals in six different Serie A seasons. AFP

